

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Rural Society and Agrarian Change - Solved Practice Workbook

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies Jajmani system?

A. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. B. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. C. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. D. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

Answer: A. Explanation: The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under Jajmani system?

A. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. B. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. C. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. D. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.

Answer: B. Explanation: The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Jajmani system?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. D. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Answer: C. Explanation: The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Jajmani system?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. D. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

Answer: D. Explanation: The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies Hereditary personalised tie?

A. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. B. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. C. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. D. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.

Answer: A. Explanation: What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under Hereditary personalised tie?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. C. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. D. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Answer: B. Explanation: What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Hereditary personalised tie?

A. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.

Answer: C. Explanation: What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Hereditary personalised tie?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. C. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. D. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

Answer: D. Explanation: What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies Jajmani decline mechanism?

A. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. D. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Answer: A. Explanation: Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under Jajmani decline mechanism?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. C. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. D. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.

Answer: B. Explanation: Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Jajmani decline mechanism?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. C. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: C. Explanation: Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Jajmani decline mechanism?

A. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. B. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. C. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. D. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.

Answer: D. Explanation: Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies Residual service ties?

A. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: A. Explanation: Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under Residual service ties?

A. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. B. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: B. Explanation: Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Residual service ties?

A. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. D. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

Answer: C. Explanation: Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Residual service ties?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. C. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. D. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Answer: D. Explanation: Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies Agrarian class structure?

A. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. B. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. C. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. D. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under Agrarian class structure?

A. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. B. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. C. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: B. Explanation: Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Agrarian class structure?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. D. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

Answer: C. Explanation: Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Agrarian class structure?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. D. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.

Answer: D. Explanation: Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies Caste-class overlap in the village?

A. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: A. Explanation: Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under Caste-class overlap in the village?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. C. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. D. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

Answer: B. Explanation: Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Caste-class overlap in the village?

A. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. B. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. D. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result.

Answer: C. Explanation: Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Caste-class overlap in the village?

A. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. B. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. C. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. D. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.

Answer: D. Explanation: Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Dominant caste?

A. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. D. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

Answer: A. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Dominant caste?

A. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. B. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. C. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. D. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive.

Answer: B. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dominant caste?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. D. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

Answer: C. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dominant caste?

A. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. B. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. C. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. D. M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.

Answer: D. Explanation: M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies Rampura evidence?

A. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. D. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

Answer: A. Explanation: Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under Rampura evidence?

A. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. B. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. C. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. D. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

Answer: B. Explanation: Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rampura evidence?

A. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. D. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

Answer: C. Explanation: Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rampura evidence?

A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.

Answer: D. Explanation: Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies Dominant caste is not the landowning class?

A. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. D. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

Answer: A. Explanation: Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under Dominant caste is not the landowning class?

A. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. B. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result.

Answer: B. Explanation: Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Dominant caste is not the landowning class?

A. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. B. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. C. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. D. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

Answer: C. Explanation: Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Dominant caste is not the landowning class?

A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. C. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. D. Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive.

Answer: D. Explanation: Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies Green Revolution differentiation?

A. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

Answer: A. Explanation: High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under Green Revolution differentiation?

A. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. B. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. C. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. D. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

Answer: B. Explanation: High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Green Revolution differentiation?

A. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. B. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. C. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. D. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.

Answer: C. Explanation: High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Green Revolution differentiation?

A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. C. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. D. High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

Answer: D. Explanation: High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Region-specific outcome?

A. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. B. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. C. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. D. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

Answer: A. Explanation: Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Region-specific outcome?

A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

Answer: B. Explanation: Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Region-specific outcome?

A. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. B. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. C. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. D. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.

Answer: C. Explanation: Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Region-specific outcome?

A. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. B. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result.

Answer: D. Explanation: Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Panchayati Raj reservation?

A. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. B. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Panchayati Raj reservation?

A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. C. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: B. Explanation: Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Panchayati Raj reservation?

A. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. B. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. C. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society

answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: C. Explanation: Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Panchayati Raj reservation?

A. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. B. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. C. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. D. Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.

Answer: D. Explanation: Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies Formal representation versus substantive power?

A. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. B. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. C. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. D. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under Formal representation versus substantive power?

A. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. B. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: B. Explanation: Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Formal representation versus substantive power?

A. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. B. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. C. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: C. Explanation: Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Formal representation versus substantive power?

A. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. B. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. C. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. D. Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

Answer: D. Explanation: Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Rural-urban continuum?

A. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. B. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: A. Explanation: The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Rural-urban continuum?

A. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. B. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. C. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: B. Explanation: The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Rural-urban continuum?

A. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. B. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. C. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. D. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Answer: C. Explanation: The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Rural-urban continuum?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. D. The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.

Answer: D. Explanation: The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies Continuum in practice?

A. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. B. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. C. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. D. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle.

Answer: A. Explanation: Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under Continuum in practice?

A. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. B. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Answer: B. Explanation: Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Continuum in practice?

A. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. B. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. C. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. D. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator.

Answer: C. Explanation: Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Continuum in practice?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. D. Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously

linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

Answer: D. Explanation: Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies Scope discipline on land law?

A. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. B. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Answer: A. Explanation: Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under Scope discipline on land law?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. C. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. D. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands.

Answer: B. Explanation: Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Scope discipline on land law?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. D. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

Answer: C. Explanation: Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Scope discipline on land law?

A. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Answer: D. Explanation: Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?

A. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. D. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Answer: A. Explanation: Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. C. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. D. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands.

Answer: B. Explanation: Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?

A. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. D. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

Answer: C. Explanation: Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Periodic Labour Force Survey boundary?

A. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. B. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle.

Answer: D. Explanation: Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Employment data cannot prove village power?

A. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. B. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. C. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. D. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands.

Answer: A. Explanation: Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Employment data cannot prove village power?

A. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. B. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. C. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. D. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

Answer: B. Explanation: Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Employment data cannot prove village power?

A. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. B. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. C. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. D. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

Answer: C. Explanation: Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Employment data cannot prove village power?

A. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. B. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator.

Answer: D. Explanation: Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies Which resource now carries power?

A. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment

often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.

Answer: A. Explanation: The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under Which resource now carries power?

A. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. B. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.

Answer: B. Explanation: The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Which resource now carries power?

A. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. B. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. C. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. D. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.

Answer: C. Explanation: The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Which resource now carries power?

A. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. B. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. C. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. D. The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Answer: D. Explanation: The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?

A. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. B. The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. C. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. D. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.

Answer: A. Explanation: No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?
Analysis: Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** D. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Q77. Which statement correctly identifies Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?

A. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. B. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. D. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Answer: B. Explanation: No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status? **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** C. What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?

A. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. B. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. C. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. D. Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.

Answer: C. Explanation: No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Demand decoding: Treat "Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?" as a definition, category, constitutional boundary, institution, mechanism and source-date-status problem. Test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?".

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status? **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** A. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the comparison axis; separate social category from legal status, right from institution and scheme from outcome; test the closest homogenisation, causation or stale-data distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar label or aggregate statistic from replacing the exact concept, institutional mandate, mechanism or evidence status.

How to improve this answer: For "Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?", state why the nearest distractor fails on definition, group variation, causation, constitutional boundary, date or status.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?

A. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. B. Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. D. No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands.

Answer: D. Explanation: No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the locally held official question papers targets rural society or agrarian change, so this owner records the absence honestly instead of inventing a recent question and prepares the recurring jajmani, dominant-caste, agrarian-change and continuum demands. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Demand decoding: Treat "Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?" as a definition, category, constitutional boundary, institution, mechanism and source-date-status problem. Test each statement.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?".

Analytical body:

- Claim and named evidence:** Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status? **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** A. Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
- Claim and named evidence:** C. Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the sociological demand in "Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: Fix the comparison axis; separate social category from legal status, right from institution and scheme from outcome; test the closest homogenisation, causation or stale-data distractor.

Why this earns marks: It prevents a familiar label or aggregate statistic from replacing the exact concept, institutional mandate, mechanism or evidence status.

How to improve this answer: For "Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Transparent zero-direct-PYQ status?", state why the nearest distractor fails on definition, group variation, causation, constitutional boundary, date or status.

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

No direct General Studies Paper-I Mains question in the audited routing ledgers or in the locally held official question papers is routed to rural society and agrarian change. This owner therefore records a transparent zero-direct-PYQ status rather than inventing a recent question, a marking scheme or an official key. The theme remains an older-pattern recurring examination area, and the six original solved Mains answers below prepare the four demand families the owner actually carries: jajmani change, dominant caste and village power, agrarian differentiation, and the rural-urban continuum. Adjacent land-reform, tenancy and poverty questions are owned by Economy and Panchayati Raj institutional design is owned by Governance, and neither is claimed here.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: No direct 2024/2025 GS-I Mains PYQ targets this topic specifically; when constructing an answer on rural society, anchor it instead to the jajmani-decline and dominant-caste concepts, which remain the syllabus's core testable content for this theme.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: No direct 2024/2025 GS-I Mains PYQ targets rural society/agrarian change specifically; this is flagged honestly rather than a fabricated question being presented as verified. When a rural-society question does appear, the expected analytical route is: define jajmani and its decline, apply the dominant-caste concept to village power, use the Green Revolution differentiation chain to explain intra-village inequality, and close with the formal-representation-versus-substantive-power gap in Panchayati Raj.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the jajmani system and account for its transformation in contemporary rural India. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: Jajmani was a hereditary, personalised patron-client exchange rather than a cash-free economy, and commercialisation, non-farm work and migration monetised it into contractual labour while leaving ritual service ties in place.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash.
- What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test.
- Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on.
- Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival.

Qualified conclusion: Jajmani was a hereditary, personalised patron-client exchange rather than a cash-free economy, and commercialisation, non-farm work and migration monetised it into contractual labour while leaving ritual service ties in place.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on "Explain the jajmani system and account for its transformation in contemporary rural India....", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Jajmani was a hereditary, personalised patron-client exchange rather than a cash-free economy, and commercialisation, non-farm work and migration monetised it into contractual labour while leaving ritual service ties in place.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The jajmani system was a historical, regionally variable patron-client arrangement in which patron households known as jajman received customary services from designated groups known as kamin, with payment often in grain or kind and sometimes in cash. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** What distinguished jajmani from a modern labour market was the hereditary, personalised patron-client tie rather than the absence of cash as such, so no-cash must never be used as the defining test. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Cash-crop commercialisation, non-farm employment and urban migration reduced patron dependence on a fixed set of hereditary service providers and broke the hereditary occupation-caste link that the arrangement rested on. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Ritual and personalised service relations persist in some places, so the defensible verdict is monetisation and transformation rather than universal disappearance, and remoteness alone cannot be used to assume survival. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Jajmani was a hereditary, personalised patron-client exchange rather than a cash-free economy, and commercialisation, non-farm work and migration monetised it into contractual labour while leaving ritual service ties in place.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Explain the jajmani system and account for its transformation in contemporary rural India....", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: What is meant by the rural-urban continuum, and why is it preferred to a rural-urban dichotomy? Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The continuum treats villages and towns as linked points on one spectrum rather than opposed types, because migration, remittance, media and market access keep rural life continuously connected to urban life.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.
- Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.

- Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Qualified conclusion: The continuum treats villages and towns as linked points on one spectrum rather than opposed types, because migration, remittance, media and market access keep rural life continuously connected to urban life.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "What is meant by the rural-urban continuum, and why is it preferred to a rural-urban...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The continuum treats villages and towns as linked points on one spectrum rather than opposed types, because migration, remittance, media and market access keep rural life continuously connected to urban life.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The continuum treats villages and towns as linked points on one spectrum rather than opposed types, because migration, remittance, media and market access keep rural life continuously connected to urban life.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 10-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise three points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "What is meant by the rural-urban continuum, and why is it preferred to a rural-urban...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Examine the concept of the dominant caste and its relevance to village power today. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Dominance built on numbers, land and office predicts everyday village authority better than ritual rank, and reserved Panchayat representation now contests that authority without displacing it.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.
- Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract.
- Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive.
- Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.
- Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.

Qualified conclusion: Dominance built on numbers, land and office predicts everyday village authority better than ritual rank, and reserved Panchayat representation now contests that authority without displacing it.

Demand decoding: The directive **examine** requires a direct position on "Examine the concept of the dominant caste and its relevance to village power today. Answer in...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Dominance built on numbers, land and office predicts everyday village authority better than ritual rank, and reserved Panchayat representation now contests that authority without displacing it.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Srinivas developed the dominant-caste concept through his Rampura village study in Karnataka, the same fieldwork that produced Sanskritisation, so the concept is located rather than abstract. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Dominant caste is a caste-level concept combining numbers, land and office, while landowning class is an economic category that can cut across several castes, so the two are usually but not necessarily coextensive. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication.

Qualification: State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Dominance built on numbers, land and office predicts everyday village authority better than ritual rank, and reserved Panchayat representation now contests that authority without displacing it.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Examine the concept of the dominant caste and its relevance to village power today. Answer in...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the social consequences of agrarian change for rural stratification in India. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: Agrarian change has restructured caste-class power more often than it has dissolved it, because productivity gains required capital, non-farm income created differentiation inside castes, and land and office remain unevenly distributed.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position.
- Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.
- High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.
- Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result.
- The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.

Qualified conclusion: Agrarian change has restructured caste-class power more often than it has dissolved it, because productivity gains required capital, non-farm income created differentiation inside castes, and land and office remain unevenly distributed.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on "Assess the social consequences of agrarian change for rural stratification in India. Answer...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Agrarian change has restructured caste-class power more often than it has dissolved it, because productivity gains required capital, non-farm income created differentiation inside castes, and land and office remain unevenly distributed.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Rural society is stratified into landowning cultivators, tenants or sharecroppers and landless agricultural labourers, a structure that often but not always correlates with caste position. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Adoption and distribution varied with crop, tenancy security, irrigation, price support and local institutions, so the Green Revolution's distributional outcome cannot be asserted as one universal result. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Agrarian change has restructured caste-class power more often than it has dissolved it, because productivity gains required capital, non-farm income created differentiation inside castes, and land and office remain unevenly distributed.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 15-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise five points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Assess the social consequences of agrarian change for rural stratification in India. Answer...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Critically examine whether formal representation in Panchayats has converted into substantive rural social power. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Reservation has created mandated voice and genuine agenda-setting in some villages while informal dominant-caste networks retain control through proxy office-holders in others, so representation is a necessary but insufficient condition.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control.
- Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy.
- M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis.
- Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it.
- Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them.

Qualified conclusion: Reservation has created mandated voice and genuine agenda-setting in some villages while informal dominant-caste networks retain control through proxy office-holders in others, so representation is a necessary but insufficient condition.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically examine** requires a direct position on "Critically examine whether formal representation in Panchayats has converted into substantive...", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Reservation has created mandated voice and genuine agenda-setting in some villages while informal dominant-caste networks retain control through proxy office-holders in others, so representation is a necessary but insufficient condition.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** Reserved seats for Scheduled Castes, Scheduled Tribes and women in Panchayats, including chairperson positions on a rotating basis, introduce formally mandated voices into village governance and contest older dominant-caste control. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Formal reserved representation does not automatically produce substantive agenda-setting power, because informal dominant-caste networks can continue to control decisions through a reserved-seat holder acting as a proxy. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** M.N. Srinivas's dominant caste combines numerical strength, a significant share of local land and political influence, and can be a middle-ranked jati rather than the ritually highest one, which makes it the practical unit of village-power analysis. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** Landownership and caste rank coincide in many villages, though tenancy reform, migration and non-farm income are loosening the correlation unevenly rather than eliminating it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** Land-ceiling and tenancy legislation mechanics and macro poverty data belong to Economy while Panchayati Raj institutional design belongs to Governance, so a Society answer cross-refers instead of re-deriving them. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Reservation has created mandated voice and genuine agenda-setting in some villages while informal dominant-caste networks retain control through proxy office-holders in others, so representation is a necessary but insufficient condition.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Critically examine whether formal representation in Panchayats has converted into substantive...", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the claim that rural India is connected to markets yet remains socially stratified. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Connection and stratification are compatible, because migration and markets change which resource carries power rather than abolishing the hierarchy, and national labour indicators cannot settle a village-level power question.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types.
- Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it.
- Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle.
- Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator.
- The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village.
- High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains.

Qualified conclusion: Connection and stratification are compatible, because migration and markets change which resource carries power rather than abolishing the hierarchy, and national labour indicators cannot settle a village-level

power question.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on "Evaluate the claim that rural India is connected to markets yet remains socially stratified....", all clauses, a sociological mechanism, historical trajectory, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, constitutional/institutional boundaries and a qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Connection and stratification are compatible, because migration and markets change which resource carries power rather than abolishing the hierarchy, and national labour indicators cannot settle a village-level power question.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The continuum model treats villages and towns as points on one spectrum linked by migration, remittance, trade, media and market access, in contrast with a dichotomy model that opposes traditional and modern types. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** Remittances from urban migrant family members, satellite media exposure and motorable road and market access keep most villages continuously linked to urban economic and cultural life rather than sealed off from it. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** Periodic Labour Force Survey data for 2023-24 is a dated rural-workforce comparator, and the Periodic Labour Force Survey Annual Report 2025, released in March 2026, is the latest annual round and uses a January-December reference period rather than the older July-June cycle. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** Employment data can contextualise rural labour change but cannot establish jajmani decline or caste dominance, which require village-level social evidence rather than a national labour indicator. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
5. **Claim and named evidence:** The analytically useful question is not whether caste-class power survived unchanged but which resource, whether land, office, network or non-farm income, now carries it in a given village. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.
6. **Claim and named evidence:** High-yielding-variety seeds, irrigation and fertiliser required upfront capital, so larger or better-connected cultivators often accessed credit and inputs earlier and could capture a disproportionate share of productivity gains. **Analysis:** Connect structure or institution -> norm/incentive/power/agency mechanism -> differentiated social outcome -> feedback or policy implication. **Qualification:** State internal group variation, regional/historical scope, correlation-versus-causation or legal-norm-versus-lived-outcome boundary.

Counter-position / limit: Neither a constitutional provision, one scheme, aggregate correlation nor a single community example establishes uniform implementation, causation or national experience; test institutions, power, agency, intersectionality, region, period and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Connection and stratification are compatible, because migration and markets change which resource carries power rather than abolishing the hierarchy, and national labour indicators cannot settle a village-level power question.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For a 20-mark answer, spend about one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing the mechanism; define and state a thesis; organise six to eight points as claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification; compress examples before mechanisms and reserve the final minute for

causation, group variation and legal-outcome limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains rather than lists, integrates India-centric evidence and avoids homogenisation, legalism and causal overclaim.

How to improve this answer: For "Evaluate the claim that rural India is connected to markets yet remains socially stratified....", replace the weakest generalisation with one named community, region, institution, movement or source-dated dataset and state what that evidence cannot establish.